KASHMIRI PANDITS

TRACKING THE EXODUS

SNAPSHOT

84,000
FAMILIES
Total number in the Valley prior to 1990

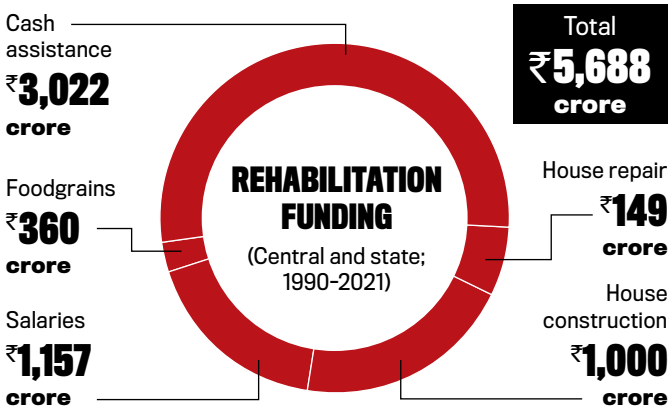
77,000
FAMILIES
Total number that fled after 1990

689
People killed by terrorists in 1990-91, as per KPSS

RELIEF MEASURES

The relief being provided includes monthly grants of Rs 3,250 per person/ Rs 13,000 per family to relief category migrants, along with nine kilos of rice and two kilos of *aata* (flour) per person and one kilo of sugar per family

44,737
KASHMIRI PANDIT FAMILIES
registered as refugees in state government records



RETURN TICKETS



2008

The Manmohan Singh government announces the first central aid package to help displaced Kashmiri Pandit families to return to the Valley

Total cost: **Rs 1,618 crore**

Jobs for youths: **3,000** (all posts filled)

Housing units: **721** (all houses occupied)



2015

The Modi government announces a second central aid package

Total cost: **Rs 920 crore**

Jobs for youths: **3,000** (selection completed)

Housing units: **6,000** (construction to be completed by 2023)

PROPERTY RESTORATION

To protect the immovable assets of refugees, the J&K government implemented the Jammu and Kashmir Migrant Immovable Property (Preservation, Protection and Restraint on Distress Sales) Act, 1997. In 2021, it launched a grievance portal to help refugees with property-related problems

Cases filed	Cases closed	Cases in process	Lands restored
7,554	5,247	2,299	610

(Sources: Department of Disaster Management, Relief, Rehabilitation and Reconstruction, J&K; Kashmiri Pandit Sangharsh Samiti)

ligence officer, who served in Kashmir during that period, reveals, "There was a sense of complacency, with various security agencies working at cross-purposes. No one ever took the threat from Pakistan and extremists seriously enough. Our attitude was that we had the state well under control and all talk of insurgency was fear-mongering."

It was to prove a costly mistake. In February 1986, the Indian government opened the locks to the disputed Babri Masjid in Ayodhya to permit Hindus to offer worship to the Ram Lalla idol there. Back in Jammu, chief minister Shah announced the construction of some prayer rooms for Muslims inside a Hindu temple in the civil secretariat, provocatively declaring, '*Islam khatre mein hai* (Islam is in danger)'. This provoked widespread communal riots in Kashmir, with Hindu-owned temples, shops and homes coming under attack. It set off the first wave of the exodus of Hindus, including Pandits.

At this point, the Congress withdrew support to the Shah government and governor's rule was imposed. By 1987, Rajiv reached an accord with Farooq Abdullah for the NC and Congress to form an alliance to contest the state election. The alliance won a majority, but the victory was marred by wide-